INCH-POUND

MIL-DTL-6839D
30 October 2007
SUPERSEDING
MIL-I-6839C
30 January 1993

DETAIL SPECIFICATION

INDICATOR, POSITION, LANDING GEAR

Inactive for new design after 2 March 1999.

This specification is approved for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

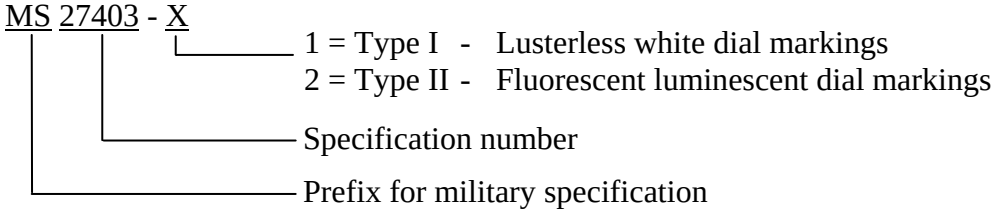
1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope. This specification covers requirements for individual 28-volt direct current (VDC) electrical landing gear position indicators.

1.2 Classification. The landing gear position indicators are of the following types as specified (see 6.2).

Type I - Lusterless white dial markings (MS27403-1)
Type II - Fluorescent luminescent dial markings (MS27403-2)

1.3 Part or identifying number (PIN). The PIN to be used for landing gear position indicators acquired to this specification is shown in MS27403.



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2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 General. The documents listed in this section are specified in sections 3 and 4 of this specification. This section does not include documents cited in other sections of this specification or recommended for additional information or as examples. While every effort has been made to ensure the completeness of this list, document users are cautioned that they must meet all specified requirements of the documents cited in sections 3 and 4 of this specification, whether or not they are listed.

2.2 Government documents.

2.2.1 Specifications and standards. The following specifications and standards form a part of this document to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of these documents are those cited in the solicitation or contract.

FEDERAL STANDARDS

FED-STD-595	- Colors Used in Government Procurement (Color chips 37038 and 37875).

DEPARTMENT OF DEFENSE SPECIFICATIONS

MIL-DTL-5541	- Chemical Conversion Coatings on Aluminum and Aluminum Alloys.
MIL-S-7742	- Screw Threads, Standard, Optimum Selected Series: General Specification for.
MIL-A-8625	- Anodic Coatings for Aluminum and Aluminum Alloys.
MS27403	- Indicator, Position, Landing Gear, 28 Volt DC.
MIL-DTL-31000	- Technical Data Packages.
MS33558	- Numerals and Letters, Aircraft Instrument Dial, Standard Form of.
MIL-DTL-83488	- Coating, Aluminum, High Purity.

DEPARTMENT OF DEFENSE STANDARDS

MIL-STD-130	- Identification Marking of U.S. Military Property.
MIL-STD-810	- Environmental Engineering Considerations and Laboratory Tests.
MIL-STD-889	- Dissimilar Metals.

(Copies of these documents are available at http://assist.daps.dla.mil/ or from the Standardization Document Order Desk, 700 Robbins Avenue, Building 4D, Philadelphia, PA 19111-5094.)

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2.2.2 Other government documents and drawings. The following other government documents and drawings form a part of this document to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of these documents are those cited in the solicitation or contract.

DRAWINGS

AIR FORCE

8988994 - Luminescent Material, Fluorescent.

(Copies of this document are available from Defense Supply Center Richmond, Attn: DSCR-VEB, 8000 Jefferson Davis Highway, Richmond, VA 23297-5616 or e-mail STDZNMGT@dla.mil.)

STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENTS

SD-6 - Provisions Governing Qualification.

(Copies of this document are available at http://assist.daps.dla.mil/ or from the Standardization Document Order Desk, 700 Robbins Avenue, Building 4D, Philadelphia, PA 19111-5094.)

2.3 Order of precedence. In the event of a conflict between the text of this document and the references cited herein (except for related specification sheets), the text of this document takes precedence. Nothing in this document, however, supersedes applicable laws and regulations unless a specific exemption has been obtained.

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Specification sheet. The individual item requirements shall be as specified herein and in accordance with the applicable specification sheet. In the event of any conflict between the requirements of this specification and the specification sheet, the latter shall govern.

3.2 Qualification. Landing gear position indicators furnished under this specification shall be products that are authorized by the qualifying activity for listing on the applicable qualified products list before contract award (see 4.3 and 6.3).

3.3 Standard parts. Except as allowed in 3.4, military standard (MS) or Air Force/Navy (AN) standard parts shall be used where they suit the purpose. They shall be identified on the drawings by their part numbers.

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3.4 Commercial parts. Commercial utility parts such as screws, bolts, nuts, or cotter pins having suitable properties may be used where there are no suitable standard parts provided:

a. They can be replaced by the standard parts (MS or AN) without alteration.
b. The corresponding standard part numbers are referenced in the parts list and if practical, on the contractors drawings.

3.5 Recycled, recovered, or environmentally preferable materials. Recycled, recovered, or environmentally preferable materials should be used to the maximum extent possible provided that the material meets or exceeds the operational and maintenance requirements and promotes economically advantageous life cycle costs.

3.6 Materials. Materials shall conform to the applicable specifications and shall be specified herein. Materials for which there are no applicable specifications, or that are not specifically described herein, shall be of the best quality, of the lightest weight, and suitable for the purpose intended.

3.6.1 Fungus-proof materials. Materials that are nutrients for fungi shall not be used where it is practical to avoid them. Where used and not hermetically sealed, they shall be treated with a fungicidal agent acceptable to the contracting activity.

3.6.2 Metals. Metals shall be of a corrosion-resistant type or suitably treated to resist corrosion due to conditions likely to be encountered in storage or normal service life.

3.6.2.1 Dissimilar metals. Dissimilar metals as defined in MIL-STD-889 shall not be used in intimate contact with each other unless suitably protected against electrolytic corrosion by means of protective coating.

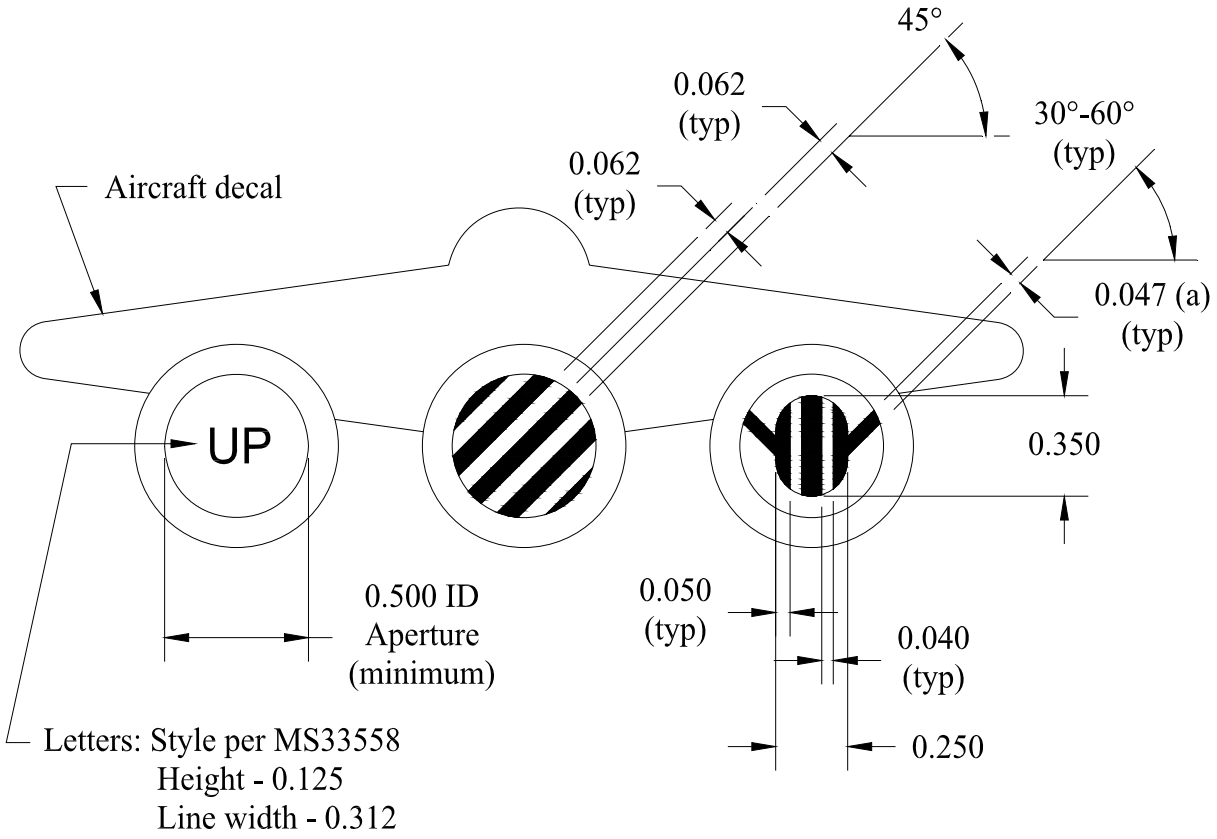
3.6.3 Non-magnetic materials. Non-magnetic materials shall be used for all parts of the instrument except where magnetic materials are essential.

3.6.4 Corrosive fumes. The materials, as installed and under normal operating conditions, shall not liberate gases or fumes that will result in corrosion that will cause malfunction of equipment or discoloration of dials.

3.7 Design and construction. The indicator shall be in accordance with MS27403. The case shall be of nonferrous low density material and shall be finished in durable dull black in accordance with FED-STD-595 color number 37038. The indicator shall be constructed so that no part will work loose in service and shall be built to withstand the strains, jars, vibration, and other conditions incident to shipping, storage, installation, and service without failure.

3.7.1 Dial indication. The indicator shall display the landing gear position by means of moveable tabs. The dimensions and appearance of the tabs shall conform to the three position indications shown in figure 1. The wheel image shall be positioned at the top of the dial drum and the letters "UP" shall be positioned at the bottom of the dial drum.

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Dimensions in inches; tolerances ±0.0156, ±5°
(a) Line width shall intersect wheel centerline at wheel edge.

FIGURE 1. Indications.

3.7.2 Power. The indicator shall be designed for operation on 28 VDC. The current required for each operating circuit shall not exceed 0.03 ampere. Resistors shall not be used to control power consumption.

3.7.3 Wiring. The indicator shall be wired so that the receptacle B terminal is common and positive. The circuit through terminal A shall activate the "UP" tab and terminal C shall activate the wheel tab.

3.7.4 Electrical receptacle. The receptacle shall be protected from corrosion. The receptacle shall be located as shown on MS27403, except that it may be moved not more than 0.1875 inch off the centerline of the indicator.

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3.7.5 Reinforcement. The inside of the case around each connection shall be of sufficient strength to prevent damage to the case when the connections are tightened during installation of the indicator.

3.7.6 Hermetically sealed case. The case shall provide a hermetically sealed enclosure for the internal mechanism. The hermetic sealing shall be accomplished so that the seal will not be dependent upon materials that will be affected by the action of any atmosphere to which the indicator may be subjected.

3.7.6.1 Helium pressure. The case shall be filled with helium of at least 98 percent purity, free from dust particles, and containing not more than 0.006 milligrams of water vapor per liter (dew point -65 °C) at the filling pressure. The absolute pressure of the helium within the case shall be approximately 1 atmosphere.

3.7.7 Marking. The top side of the case shall be marked "THIS END UP" to facilitate proper mounting of the indicator. The marking, "THIS END UP", along with an arrow pointing toward the top of the case, may be placed on each side of the case in lieu of the top.

3.7.8 Cover glass. The cover glass shall be clear and free from flaws that interfere with normal reading of the indicator. The thickness of the glass shall be suitable for the purpose and shall not exceed 0.047 inch. The distance between the inside surface of the cover glass and the arc of the dial shall not exceed 0.0312 inch.

3.8 Performance. The indicator shall be capable of satisfactory operation when subjected to the following conditions:

a. Temperatures ranging from -54 °C to 71 °C.
b. Exposure to salt-sea atmosphere.
c. Vibration incident to service use.
d. Shock forces of 100 g.
e. Thermal shock.
f. Immersion in a deaerated liquid without leaking.

3.9 Interchangeability. All parts having the same manufacturer's part number shall be functionally and dimensionally interchangeable. The drawing number requirements of MIL-DTL-31000 shall govern changes in the manufacturer's part numbers.

3.10 Markings.

3.10.1 Dial markings. All markings shall be durable enough to withstand the usage encountered in service. Lettering style and size shall be as specified in figure 1.

3.10.2 Dial marking material. Type I indicator markings shall be in a white lusterless material matching FED-STD-595 color number 37875. Type II indicator markings shall be fluorescent-luminescent material in accordance with 8988994, type I or type III as applicable.

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3.10.3 Dial background color. The background of the dial and all other markings not otherwise specified shall be finished in lusterless black matching FED-STD-595 color number 37038.

3.11 Weight. The weight of the completely assembled indicator, without the mounting screws, shall not exceed 2.5 ounces.

3.12 Screw threads. Unless otherwise specified herein, the threads of all machine screws 0.060 inch or larger in diameter shall conform to MIL-S-7742.

3.13 Finishes and protective coatings.

3.13.1 Aluminum alloy parts. Aluminum alloy parts shall be covered with an anodic film conforming to MIL-A-8625, except as follows:

a. Dials, small holes, and case inserts need not be anodized.
b. Aluminum alloys that do not anodize satisfactorily shall be coated with a chemical film in accordance with MIL-DTL-5541.
c. Where the primary purpose of the treatment is to provide a suitable paint base, chemical treatments in accordance with MIL-DTL-5541 may be used in lieu of anodizing.
d. Castings containing non-aluminum alloy integral inserts may be treated with a chemical film in accordance with MIL-DTL-5541 in lieu of anodizing.
e. When abrasion resistance is a factor, chemical films in accordance with MIL-DTL-5541 shall not be used in lieu of anodizing.
f. Parts contained within hermetically sealed enclosures are considered to be suitably protected without anodizing or plating.

3.13.2 Steel parts. Steel parts shall be coated with ion vapor deposited aluminum, where practicable, in accordance with MIL-DTL-83488, type I or type II, as applicable, and of a class that is adequate to achieve the degree of protection required. Other protective coating may be used in lieu of MIL-DTL-83488 if demonstrated to be satisfactory and approved by the contracting officer. Cadmium plating must be avoided when satisfactory alternative processes can be used.

3.14 Identification of product. A nameplate shall be securely attached to the outside of the case and shall be legibly and durably marked in accordance with MIL-STD-130.

3.15 Workmanship. The indicator, including all parts and accessories, shall be constructed and finished in a thoroughly workmanlike manner. Particular attention shall be given to neatness and thoroughness of soldering, marking of parts and assemblies, and freedom of parts from burrs and sharp edges.

3.16 Installation.

3.16.1 Mounting screws. The contractor shall furnish the required mounting screws and lock washers to install the indicator. Screws shall be number 6-32 round head, brass machine screws, NC-2, with a durable dull black finish and of the proper length to permit mounting on a panel 0.125 inch thick.

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3.16.2 Envelope. An envelope containing the required screws and lock washers shall be furnished with each indicator. The face of the envelope shall be marked to indicate the contents.

4. VERIFICATION

4.1 Classification of inspections. The inspection requirements specified herein are classified as follows:

a. Qualification inspection (see 4.3).
b. Conformance inspection (see 4.4).

4.2 Inspection conditions. Except where otherwise specified, all inspections shall be performed in accordance with the test conditions specified in 4.2.1 through 4.2.4.

4.2.1 Standard atmospheric conditions. Whenever the pressure and temperature are not specified, the test shall be made at atmospheric pressure (approximately 29.92 inches Hg) and at room temperature (approximately 25 °C). When tests are made with atmospheric pressure or room temperature differing from the above values, proper allowance shall be made for the difference from the specified condition.

4.2.2 Attitude. Except where otherwise specified, the indicator shall be tested in the normal operating position.

4.2.3 Vibration. A vibration stand that will vibrate at any desired frequency between 300 cycles per minute (cpm) and 3,000 cpm shall be used to subject the indicator to vibration such that a point on the case will describe in a plane inclined at 45 degrees to the horizontal plane, a circle, the diameter of which is equal to the amplitude specified herein.

4.2.4 Voltage input. Except where otherwise specified, the indicator shall be tested with 28 VDC.

4.3 Qualification inspection.

4.3.1 Test samples. The test samples shall consist of two indicators. Samples shall be identified with the manufacturer's part number and any additional information required by the qualifying activity.

4.3.2 Qualification inspection. The qualification inspection shall consist of the individual tests of 4.4.1 and the sampling tests of 4.4.2.

4.4 Conformance inspection. Conformance inspection shall consist of:

a. Individual tests (see 4.4.1).
b. Sampling tests (see 4.4.2).

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4.4.1 Individual tests. Each indicator shall be subjected to the following tests:

a. Examination of product (see 4.5.1).
b. Operation (see 4.5.2).
c. Friction (see 4.5.3).
d. Indicator position (see 4.5.4).
e. Dielectric strength (see 4.5.5).
f. Sealing (see 4.5.17).

4.4.2 Sampling tests.

4.4.2.1 Sampling plan A. Five indicators selected at random from every 500 or less on the acquisition order shall be subjected to the following tests:

a. Low temperature operation (see 4.5.6).
b. High temperature operation (see 4.5.7).
c. Magnetic effect (see 4.5.8).
d. Vibration error (see 4.5.9).
e. Shock test (see 4.5.10).
f. Voltage variation (see 4.5.13).

4.4.2.2 Sampling plan B. Unless otherwise specified (see 6.2), three indicators selected at random from the first 15 items of the acquisition order shall be subjected to the following tests:

a. Low temperature exposure (see 4.5.11).
b. High temperature exposure (see 4.5.12).
c. Voltage variation (see 4.5.13).
d. Indicator life (see 4.5.14).
e. Vibration failure (see 4.5.15).
f. Salt fog (see 4.5.16).
g. Thermal shock (see 4.5.18).

4.5 Test methods.

4.5.1 Examination of product. Each indicator shall be inspected to determine conformance with this specification with respect to material and workmanship.

4.5.2 Operation. The indicator shall be connected to a 28 VDC source and a single-pole double-throw switch or an equivalent circuit. The B terminal shall be positive and common. The circuit shall be completed alternately through terminals A and C and the "UP" tab and wheel tab shall appear respectively. When current is not applied to either terminal, the unlocked tab shall appear as shown in figure 1.

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4.5.3 Friction. The indicator shall be operated as above, except that the indication before and after tapping shall be noted. The indicator shall be in the normal upright mounting position and shall be tapped only after the tab has come to rest. The difference in the indication before and after tapping shall not exceed 1/32 inch of tab movement.

4.5.4 Indicator position. The indication shall be noted with the indicator energized in the "UP" position, unlocked, and wheel indications for the following positions:

a. Normal upright dial vertical position.
b. Tipped 90 degrees rearward, the dial horizontal and face up.
c. Tipped 90 degrees to the right, the dial in a vertical plane.
d. Tipped 90 degrees to the left, the dial in a vertical plane.

The maximum deviation of reading for (b), (c), and (d) shall not exceed 1/32 inch of tab movement.

4.5.5 Dielectric strength. The application of 200 volts, 60 cycles per second (cps) for a 5-second interval between the individual pins and the indicator case shall cause no evidence of insulation breakdown.

4.5.6 Low temperature operation. The indicator shall be subjected to a temperature of -54 °C ± 2 °C for a period of 4 hours. At the end of this period and while still at -54 °C, the indicator shall be subjected to, and shall meet the requirements of, the tests specified in 4.5.2 and 4.5.3. After the indicator has returned to room temperature, it shall be subjected to and shall meet the requirements of the tests specified in 4.5.2 and 4.5.3.

4.5.7 High temperature operation. The indicator shall be subjected to a temperature of 71 °C ± 2 °C for a period of 4 hours. At the end of this period and while still at 71 °C, the indicator shall be subjected to, and shall meet the requirements of, the tests specified in 4.5.2 and 4.5.3. After the indicator has returned to room temperature, it shall be subjected to and shall meet the requirements of the tests specified in 4.5.2 and 4.5.3.

4.5.8 Magnetic effect. The indicator, first not operating, and second, operating on rated voltage, shall be rotated in a vertical plane about a short bar magnet compass with the nearest part of the indicator 5-1/2 inches from magnetically east or west of the center of the compass. Starting directly under the compass, the indicator shall be held in positions of 0 degrees, 45 degrees, 90 degrees, 135 degrees, 180 degrees, 225 degrees, 270 degrees, and 315 degrees from the initial position. At each of these positions, the indicator shall be rotated on its own horizontal axis until it is in its normal position. The horizontal magnetic field intensity shall be 0.17 oersted to 0.19 oersted. The deflection of the compass at any of the specified positions shall not exceed 3 degrees.

4.5.9 Vibration error. The indicator shall be mounted on the vibration stand in its normal operating position. The indicator shall be operated on 28 VDC and shall be subjected to vibration from 5 cps to 50 cps with an amplitude of 0.009 inch to 0.011 inch. The maximum amplitude of the moveable tab vibration and the tab variation shall not exceed 1/32 inch when the indication is in either the "UP" or "DOWN" position.

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4.5.10 Shock test. The indicator shall be subjected to 18 impact shocks of 100 g in accordance with MIL-STD-810, Method 516, "Shock", functional shock procedure. Each shock impulse shall have a time duration of 7.5 milliseconds (ms) ± 1 ms. The intensity shall be within ±10 percent when measured with a filter having a bandwidth of 5 cps to 100 cps. The maximum g shall be reached in approximately 3.75 ms. The shock shall be applied in the following directions:

a. Vertical axis, three shocks in each direction.
b. Horizontal axis (major and minor), three shocks in each direction.

This test shall be accomplished on three indicators with the power off and one indicator with pins A and B energized and on one indicator with pins C and B energized. Upon completion of this test, the indicators shall be tested and must comply with all of the tests specified in 4.4.1.

4.5.11 Low temperature exposure. The indicator shall be subjected to a temperature of -64 °C ± 2 °C for a period of 48 hours. While still at this temperature, the indicator shall be operated throughout its range without exhibiting sticking or erratic characteristics. The temperature shall then be raised to -54 °C ± 2 °C for a period of 24 hours. At the end of this period and while still at -54 °C, the indicator shall be subjected to and shall meet the requirements of the tests specified in 4.5.2 and 4.5.3. Upon returning to room temperature, the indicator shall be subjected to and shall meet the requirements of the tests specified in 4.5.2 and 4.5.3.

4.5.12 High temperature exposure. The indicator shall be subjected to a temperature of 71 °C ± 2 °C for a period of 24 hours. At the end of this period and while still at 71 °C, the indicator shall be subjected to and shall meet the requirements of the tests specified in 4.5.2 and 4.5.3. Upon returning to room temperature, the indicator shall be subjected to and shall meet the requirements of the tests specified in 4.5.2 and 4.5.3.

4.5.13 Voltage variation. The indicator shall be operated at a reduced voltage of 22-1/2 VDC and an increased voltage of 30 VDC. There shall not be more than 1/32 inch movement of the tab between operation at the reduced voltage and operation at the increased voltage. The indicator shall be tapped lightly after each change in voltage.

4.5.14 Indicator life. The indicator shall be operated for 20,000 cycles at a rate of 10 cpm to 12 cpm. A cycle shall consist of movement from the unlocked position to the "UP" locked position, to the unlocked position, to the wheel "DOWN" position and back to the unlocked position. Upon completion of the test, the indicator shall be subjected to and shall meet the requirements of the tests specified in 4.5.2 and 4.5.3.

4.5.15 Vibration failure. The indicator shall be subjected to a vibration test in accordance with MIL-STD-810, Method 514, "Vibration", operational propeller aircraft category of the general vibration procedure. The test shall last for a period of three hours. After the vibration test, the indicator shall be subjected to and shall meet the requirements of the tests specified in 4.5.2 and 4.5.3.

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4.5.16 Salt fog. The indicator shall be subjected to salt fog in accordance with MIL-STD-810, Method 509, "Salt Fog", except fog shall be continuous for 50 hours. At the end of this period, the indicator shall be examined. There shall be no corrosion or resultant damage from this test. The indicator shall then be subjected to and shall meet the requirements of the tests specified in 4.5.2, 4.5.3, and 4.5.5.

4.5.17 Sealing. The indicator shall be subjected to immersion in accordance with MIL-STD-810, Method 512, "Immersion", immersion procedure. The absolute pressure of the air above the liquid shall be reduced by 1 inch Hg then increased by 2.5 inches Hg for one hour.

4.5.18 Thermal shock. The indicator shall be subjected to 8 cycles of exposure to water at 85 °C ± 2 °C and 5 °C ± 2 °C without evidence of penetration or damage to the coating or enclosure. Each cycle of the test shall consist of immersing the indicator in 85 °C ± 2 °C water for a period of 25 minutes, and then within 5 seconds of removal from the bath, immersing the indicator in 5 °C ± 2 °C water for a period of 25 minutes. This cycle shall be repeated continuously until 8 cycles have been completed. The indicator shall then be subjected to and shall meet the requirements of the sealing test specified in 4.5.17. No indicator leakage shall occur as a result of thermal shock.

4.6 Maintenance of qualification. At specified intervals determined by the qualifying activity, the manufacturer must be able to demonstrate that the company still has the capabilities and facilities necessary to produce the QPL items in accordance with this specification and in accordance with the provisions governing qualification specified in SD-6.

5. PACKAGING

5.1 Packaging. For acquisition purposes, the packaging requirements shall be as specified in the contract or order (see 6.2). When packaging of materiel is to be performed by DoD or in-house contractor personnel, these personnel need to contact the responsible packaging activity to ascertain packaging requirements. Packaging requirements are maintained by the inventory control point's packaging activities within the military service or defense agency, or within the military service's system command. Packaging data retrieval is available from the managing military department's or defense agency's automated packaging files, CD-ROM products, or by contacting the responsible packaging activity.

6. NOTES

(This section contains information of a general or explanatory nature that may be helpful, but is not mandatory.)

6.1 Intended use. The individual landing gear position indicator covered by this specification is intended for use on all aircraft with retractable landing gear where indication of the position of the landing gear is desired.

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6.2 Acquisition requirements. Acquisition documents should specify the following:

a. Title, number, and date of this specification.
b. Type (see 1.2).
c. Sampling plan B quantity, if other than specified (see 4.4.2.2).
d. Packaging (see 5.1).

6.3 Qualification. With respect to products requiring qualification, awards will be made only for products that are, at the time of award of contract, qualified for inclusion in QPL-6839 whether or not such products have actually been listed by that date. The attention of the contractors is called to these requirements, and manufacturers are urged to arrange to have the products that they propose to offer to the Federal Government tested for qualification in order that they may be eligible to be awarded contracts or orders for the products covered by this specification. Information pertaining to qualification of products may be obtained from Defense Supply Center Richmond, Attn: DSCR-VEB, 8000 Jefferson Davis Highway, Richmond, VA 23297 or STDZNMGT@dla.mil.

6.4 Subject term (key word) listing.

28 volt
aircraft
dial
retractable

6.5 Changes from previous issue. Marginal notations are not used in this revision to identify changes with respect to the previous issue due to the extent of the changes.

Custodians:
Army - AV
Navy - AS
Air Force - 99

Preparing Activity:
DLA - GS1

(Project 6610-0613-000)

Review Activities:
Army - MI
Navy - MC
Air Force - 11

NOTE: The activities listed above were interested in this document as of the date of this document. Since organizations and responsibilities can change, you should verify the currency of the information above using the ASSIST database at http://assist.daps.dla.mil/.

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